VIT BHOPAL

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

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YOUR LEARNING DESTINATION

Name: Shivang Sharma
Registration no: 25BCE10160
Branch: Computer Science (core)
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Introduction

In this ever-changing 21st-century environment, digital literacy has moved from a skill to a necessity for academic and professional success. As a newly appointed Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal University, my key objective is to act as a guide for my fellow students, assisting them in navigating the complexities of this digital world with confidence, safety, and professionalism. This not only demands a theoretical understanding of digital literacy but also a practical capability to execute this understanding in a college environment.

The following report will discuss my assignment in creating my Digital Literacy Portfolio, a comprehensive project designed to demonstrate my proficiency in five key areas. This assignment consists of a wide variety of tasks, from designing educational infographics to creating a professional presence on platforms such as LinkedIn and GitHub, along with mastering key tools in collaborating and communicating with fellow students. Moreover, this assignment will address the critical requirement for students to become aware of cyber issues by exploring real-world security issues and their prevention mechanisms. By structuring these key deliverables in a GitHub repository, this project will establish a permanent digital footprint, demonstrating my growth as a responsible digital citizen and student leader.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I have created a one-page infographic on Digital Literacy Essentials for Students using Canva. The design of the infographic is based on effectively defining the concept of digital literacy and its significance in a student's life. The essential components of the infographic include defining what digital literacy is, the use of digital tools, internet safety, and creating a professional online presence.

The infographic is designed by dividing it into different color-coded sections and icons to make it visually attractive and understandable. Each section of the infographic provides information in a concise manner so that students are able to quickly understand important concepts without feeling confused. The infographic is created in such a manner that it is not only informative but also visually attractive and appealing for sharing among students.

The major difficulty I faced while working on this task is to maintain a proper balance between design and content so that the infographic is not only not filled with information but also provides important information to readers. I found it an interesting experience how a design plays a significant role in enhancing the level of understanding.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task I made my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle to have a strong and professional online presence. GitHub is used to showcase coding projects and track progress in programming making GitHub an important platform for demonstrating skills. On LinkedIn I can connect with people, share my education and look for career opportunities. LinkedIn serves as a networking platform where I can present my academic background, connect with peers and professionals and explore career opportunities with LinkedIn. Kaggle is useful for learning data science concepts, participating in competitions and practicing with real-world datasets on Kaggle.

Over the four years I will use these platforms to improve. I plan to use these platforms to grow both academically and professionally. On GitHub I will upload projects, get better at coding and regularly upload projects.. On LinkedIn I aim to build a network, share achievements and stay updated with industry trends on LinkedIn.. On Kaggle I intend to enhance my skills by working on datasets and participating in competitions. These platforms will help me have a profile and prepare for internships and jobs. Overall these platforms will help me develop a rounded profile and prepare for future internships and job opportunities.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this task, I have used HackerRank for practicing coding skills and Google Forms for designing a collaborative quiz. At HackerRank, I have attempted the beginner-level problem "Solve Me First," in which I have written a simple code for adding two numbers. Even though this problem is simple, I have understood the need for a structured solution format required by the coding platforms. I have also understood the need for avoiding redundant code in the solution. Moreover, I have understood the need for following the format exactly as required by the platforms.

Using Google Forms, I have designed a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz consisting of five questions. I have understood the need for such tools in academic environments for efficient collaboration, data collection, and communication. I have understood the usefulness of such tools for conducting surveys, quizzes, and feedback collection in academic environments.

These platforms will help me academically by improving programming skills and problem-solving skills. At the same time, I have understood the need for collaboration, data collection, and communication in academic environments, which can be achieved through tools like Google Forms.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

An example of a situation where there was a problem due to poor digital communication is where a student sends an email to the professor with an unclear subject line, informal content, and an absence of greeting. The professor might not respond well to the student's request, which might result in the student missing the deadline. For example, the student might write an email with the subject line “Hey, I need help ASAP” but forget to provide the context for the request. This might negatively influence the way the student is perceived.

One thing that could have been done differently is ensuring the subject line is clear, the content is professional, and the student explains the issue well. This is an example of the role that small details play in the outcome of the communication.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

The thing that surprised me the most when researching on this topic was that psychological tactics such as fear and urgency alone are enough to allow scammers to be successful. Even educated people, such as college students, can be victims if they are not careful. I also learned that people are not aware that UPI PINs should not be shared, and also, they should not be entering a PIN to receive money. Another thing that surprised me was that money can be transferred within minutes, and thus, immediate reporting is a necessity. This has also made me realize, as a Digital Ambassador, how awareness of such minute details can make a huge difference in preventing cybercrime.

Conclusion

Completing the Digital Literacy Portfolio has been an eye-opening experience in my role as a Student Digital Ambassador. The five modules of CSE0001 have taken me from an inactive participant in the world of technology to an active, educated, and responsible member of the digital world. This project not only gives me the technical knowledge required to effectively utilize tools such as GitHub and cloud collaboration but also the understanding of the ethics required to be successful in the world of academia.

By creating my professional presence on sites such as LinkedIn and HackerRank, I have set myself up for success in the future as I move forward in the next four years. By researching the world of cybercrime prevention and professional communication, I have also learned the necessity of safety and etiquette in every interaction with the digital world. This portfolio is not only a permanent record of my growth in the world of technology but also one that I can confidently present to my peers in the hopes of creating a more digitally literate community.

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